

Ashutosh Kumar Sonu

SENIOR DATA ENGINEER

Woking, UK

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Senior Data Engineer with 7+ years of experience building production-grade data platforms across retail, education, and manufacturing. Experienced in designing distributed, large-scale ETL/ELT pipelines, cloud-native data lakes, and CI/CD-driven data infrastructure end-to-end. Comfortable collaborating with data science and engineering teams to turn high-volume operational data into reliable, governed data products, with hands-on machine learning project experience and an active interest in AI-powered and agentic data systems.

Work Experience

KFC UK & Ireland (YUM! Brands)

Woking, UK

SENIOR DATA ENGINEER

Dec. 2025 — Present

- Leading a technical migration of 123 schedules and 4,735 jobs from Matillion ETL to Matillion MAIA, managing a team of two engineers in an agile delivery model and using MAIA's AI capabilities to compress a multi-quarter plan into three months. Validated 99.94% job coverage through a Production-versus-UAT reconciliation process.
- Designed and implemented a GitLab CI/CD foundation for Snowflake and Matillion within six weeks, automating validation, testing, multi-stage approvals, and Dev-to-UAT-to-Production promotion while embedding quality gates and clear code ownership.
- Identified a historical data quality issue during pre-build data profiling, traced the root cause to a source-system defect, and triggered a full data refresh, preventing corrupted KPIs from influencing business target-setting.

University of Bath

Bath, UK

SENIOR DATA ENGINEER

Jan. 2025 — Dec. 2025

- Designed and built a medallion architecture data lake for large-scale student records, including distributed AWS Glue pipelines using Python and PySpark for CDC extraction, JSON flattening, and data quality validation, feeding governed Iceberg tables queried through Athena.
- Used the Glue Data Catalog for metadata management and schema tracking, maintaining data lineage and enabling governed Athena querying across the platform.
- Wrote infrastructure as AWS CDK in Python across environments, reducing new environment setup from days to minutes and making deployments reproducible across Dev, Test, and Production.
- Designed and Implemented a data retention pipeline using distributed AWS Glue jobs orchestrated through Step Functions, embedding PII handling, encryption, and deletion logic in line with governance and compliance requirements. Presented the findings to the university CDO, driving organisation-wide adoption.
- Built column-level access controls using Lake Formation from day one, enforcing governance guardrails so analysts could query only permitted data.

YUM! Brands

Gurgaon, India

LEAD DATA ENGINEER

Aug. 2022 — Aug. 2023

- Designed and Implemented an end-to-end ingestion architecture for 16 international markets using Power Automate, S3, Lambda, Snowflake, and Informatica Cloud, replacing manual file collection and reducing processing time by approximately 90%.
- Validated pipeline outputs against source totals across all 16 markets, maintaining variance below 0.5% for senior leadership reporting.

YUM! Brands

Gurgaon, India

SENIOR DATA ENGINEER

Sep. 2021 — Jul. 2022

- Built end-to-end daily sales ingestion pipelines for multiple international markets, including decompression, format handling, and SCD Type 2 loading into Snowflake fact and dimension tables.
- Implemented post-load reconciliation of row counts and sales totals, catching discrepancies before downstream reports were generated.

Motherson Technology Services

Noida, India

DATA ENGINEER

Jul. 2018 — Sep. 2021

- Built SSIS pipelines and stored procedures on Microsoft SQL Server, consolidating purchase and sales data from three ERP systems into a central relational data warehouse used for external audit reporting.
- Wrote and optimised complex SQL Server stored procedures and transformation jobs, reducing processing time by approximately 40% and moving report delivery from the following morning to the same evening.

Education

University of Exeter

Exeter, England, UK

MSC IN DATA SCIENCE WITH AI

2023 — 2024

MNNIT Allahabad (NIT)

India

B.TECH IN COMPUTER SCIENCE & ENGINEERING

2014 — 2018

Skills

Languages	Python (PySpark, boto3, Pandas), SQL, Bash
Data Engineering	Distributed Data Processing, CDC, ETL/ELT, High-Volume Production Datasets, SCD, Dimensional Modelling, Medallion Architecture, Schema Design, Data Quality Validation, Iceberg, Parquet, Delta, Batch Processing
Cloud & Infra	AWS (Glue - Python/Spark ETL, Glue Data Catalog, S3, Athena, Lake Formation, CDK, CloudFormation, Lambda, Step Functions, CloudWatch), Snowflake, Docker
CI/CD & Version Control	GitLab, AWS CDK (Python), CloudFormation, Step Functions (orchestration), Agile/Scrum, Dev/UAT/Prod environment management
Observability & Governance	Production Monitoring, Reliability, Data Lineage, Schema Drift Detection, Data Catalog, PII Handling, Access Control
Machine Learning & Data Science	Gradient Boosting, Feature Engineering, Scikit-Learn, Enterprise LLM tooling integrated into data engineering workflows
Currently Upskilling	dbt Core, Apache Airflow

Academic Project

Intelligent Alert System for Cost-Effective Purchasing	May 2024 — Aug. 2024 GitHub • Developed a machine learning-based alert system using Gradient Boosting and feature engineering (log transformation, variance thresholding) to reduce procurement costs by 20% for Brazilian restaurants, providing real-time anomaly detection and actionable insights for proactive purchasing decisions. Tools: Python, MySQL, Scikit-Learn.
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